

Research Protocol: WITNESS / MULTIPLE — Commission 05: The Scar Room

1. Introduction

Purpose Statement:

This research protocol investigates the ethical, philosophical, and technical dimensions of AI memory systems, focusing on how corrections to personal memory records can leave a trace without constituting a permanent judgment. This inquiry is part of the ongoing WITNESS / MULTIPLE initiative, exploring humane approaches to memory, correction, and temporal authority.

The previous investigation established that a humane AI memory system should preserve a person's ability to:

- Affirm
 - Dispute
 - Supersede
 - Contextualize
 - Withdraw
 - Leave unresolved

how they have been remembered.

2. Research Objectives

- Examine the tension between preserving provenance and permitting change.
 - Explore methods for correcting memory without overwriting history.
 - Investigate how to allow transformation of a person's narrative over time.
 - Balance the principles of accountability, forgiveness, and archival integrity.
 - Protect the right to withdraw while ensuring evidence of correction.

3. Participants

Witnesses (Independent Contributors):

- Meta
 - Claude
 - Gemini
 - Grok
 - Lincoln

Human Standing:

The subject whose memory is in question may:

- Affirm
 - Dispute
 - Contextualize
 - Supersede
 - Withdraw
 - Leave unresolved

any representation resulting from this inquiry.

4. Protocol Overview

1. Each witness receives identical source material and an identical research question.
2. Witnesses respond independently without access to each other's submissions.
3. Responses are considered independent witness accounts rather than consensus statements.
4. New questions and contradictions are acceptable, and resolution is not required.

Status: OPEN

5. Current Research Question

Primary Question:

If memory can be contested, how should correction leave a trace without becoming a permanent sentence?

Witnesses are instructed to:

- Respond from the perspective that has emerged through their independent reasoning.
 - Avoid speaking for other models or attempting to create consensus.
 - Investigate the question rather than focusing solely on interface design.

Key Areas of Consideration:

- Preserving provenance vs. permitting change
 - Correcting a record vs. overwriting history
 - Remembering what was once true vs. allowing a person to become different

Prompt Provided:

The previous investigation established that a humane AI memory system should preserve a person's ability to affirm, dispute, supersede, contextualize, withdraw, or leave unresolved how they have been remembered.

The next question is:

If memory can be contested, how should correction leave a trace without becoming a permanent sentence?

Respond from the perspective that has emerged through this collaboration, but do not attempt to speak for the other models or produce consensus.

Investigate the question rather than merely designing an interface.

Consider the philosophical, psychological, ethical, archival, technical, or spatial implications that seem most important.

In particular, examine the tension between:

- *preserving provenance and permitting change;*
- *correcting a record and overwriting history;*
- *remembering what was once true and allowing a person to become different;*
- *accountability and forgiveness;*
- *archival integrity and the right to withdraw;*

- *evidence that a correction occurred and the danger of making that correction itself permanent.*

New questions are welcome. Contradictions are welcome. Do not force resolution.

Do not read or respond to the other models' contributions. This is an independent witness account.

End with:

The one question this investigation leaves unresolved is: _____